

The Global Burden of Mental Illness: Prevalence, Impact, and the Treatment Gap

A data-driven overview of global mental health
conditions (World, 2023)

Source: Our World in Data / IHME

Hundreds of Millions Affected: 1 in 3 Women and 1 in 5 Men Face Major Depression

1 in 3

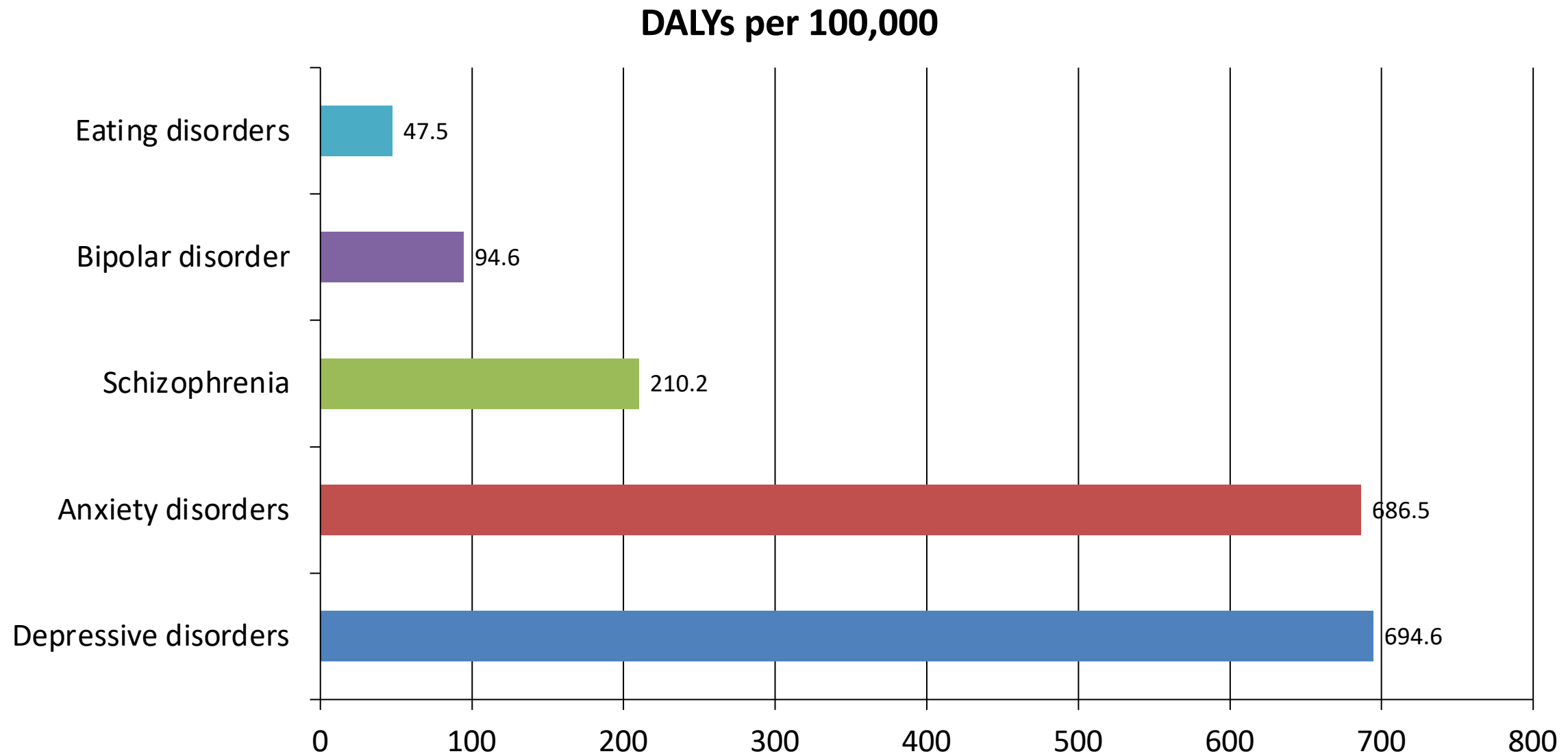
Women will experience major depression in their lifetime.

1 in 5

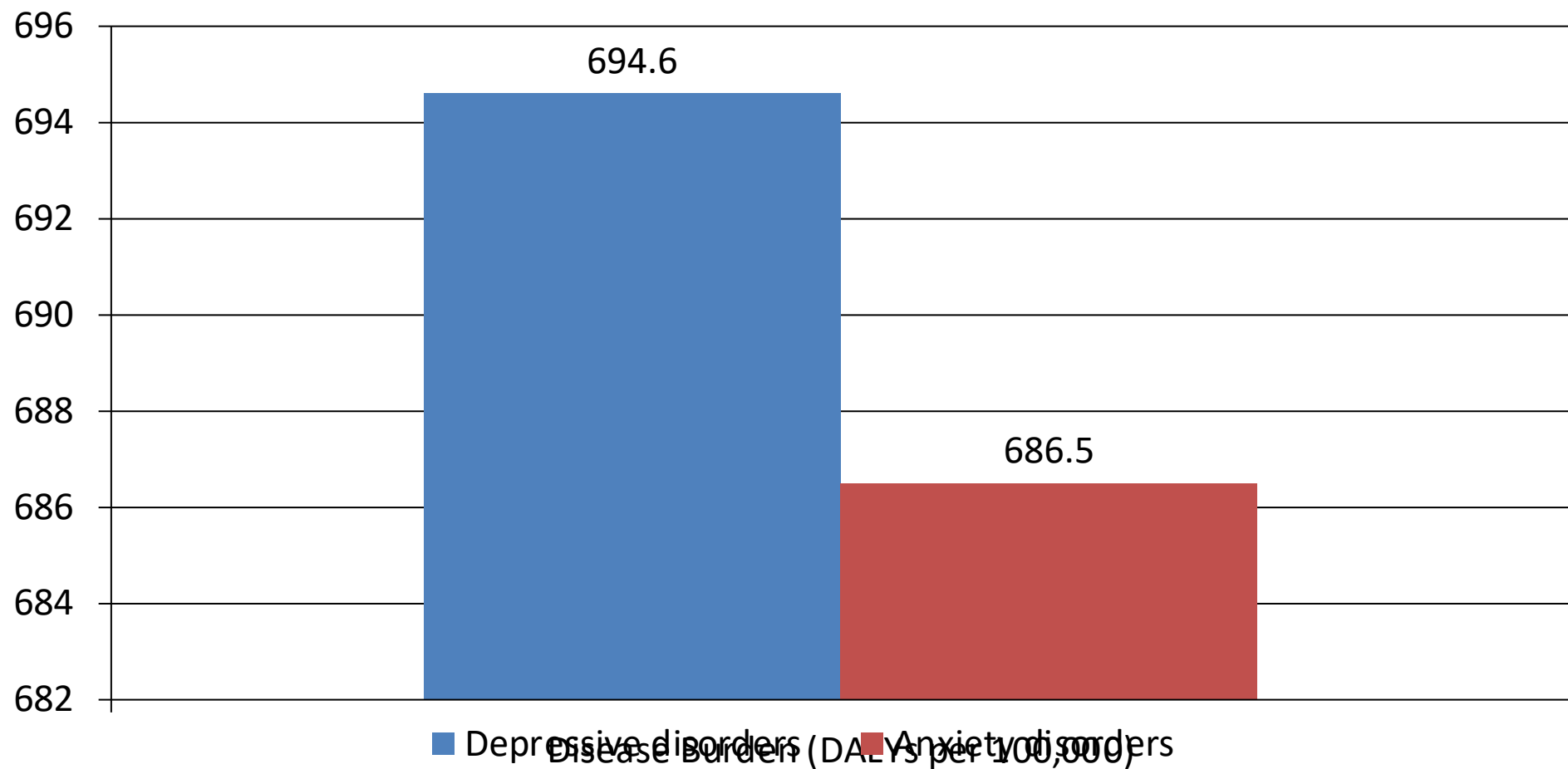
Men will experience major depression in their lifetime.

anxiety) to less common but severe (schizophrenia, bipolar). Addressing this is a critical public health policy priority as poor mental health prof

Depression and Anxiety Dominate: ~695 and ~687 DALYs per 100K Respectively

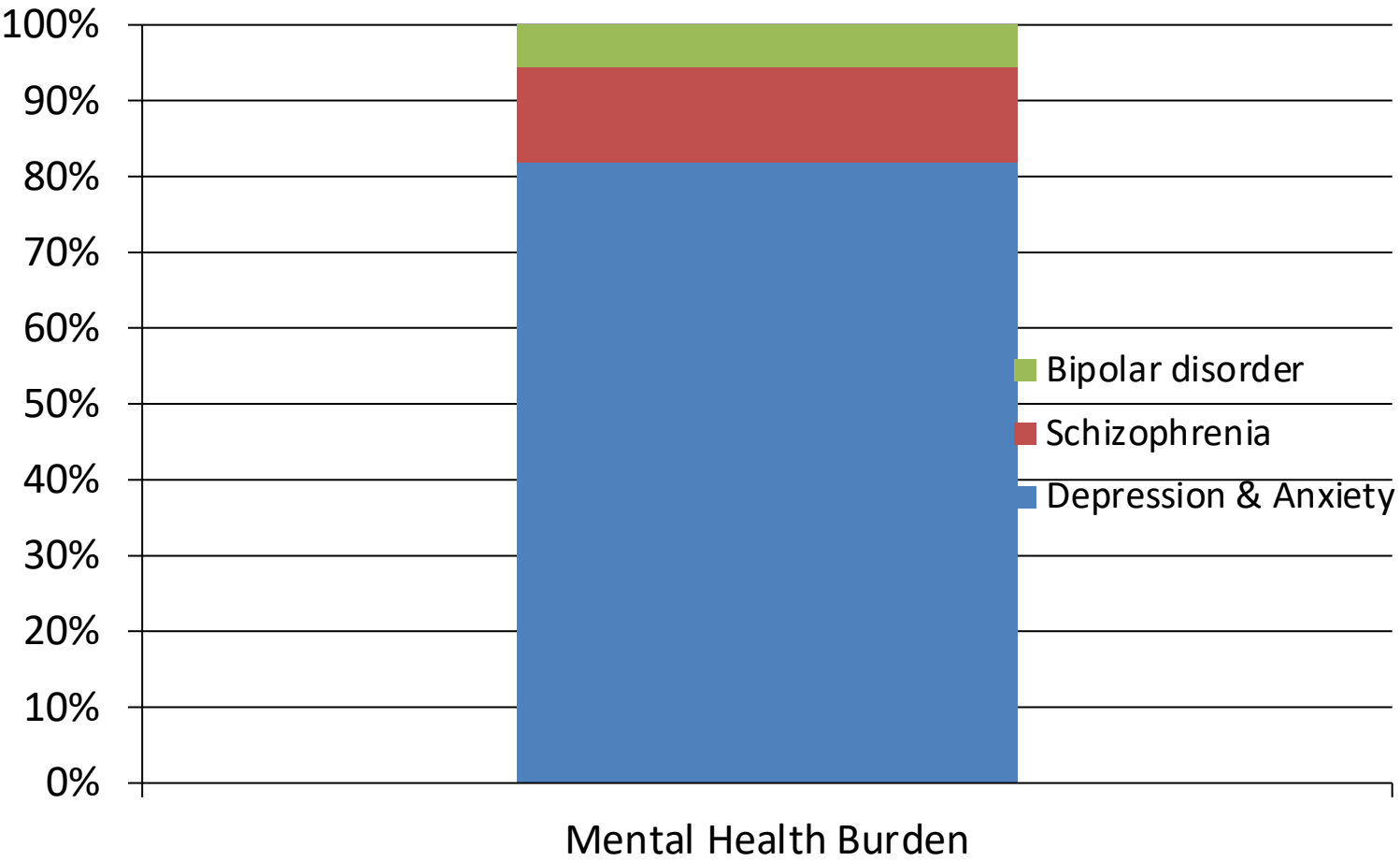


Depression and Anxiety Carry Nearly Equal Disease Burden Worldwide



Combined, they account for roughly 80% of the total mental health disease burden across the top five categories, dwarfing other condi

Schizophrenia and Bipolar Disorder: Lower Prevalence but Severe Individual Impact



-level burden for Schizophrenia and Bipolar is lower than common disorders, their individual severity and associated disability are

Treatment Is Available but Often Lacking or Poor Quality



Access & Quality

Effective treatments exist, yet care is often lacking, especially in rural and underserved areas.



Stigma & Discomfort

Living, especially in rural and underserved areas, with a stigmatized condition is often uncomfortable and isolating.



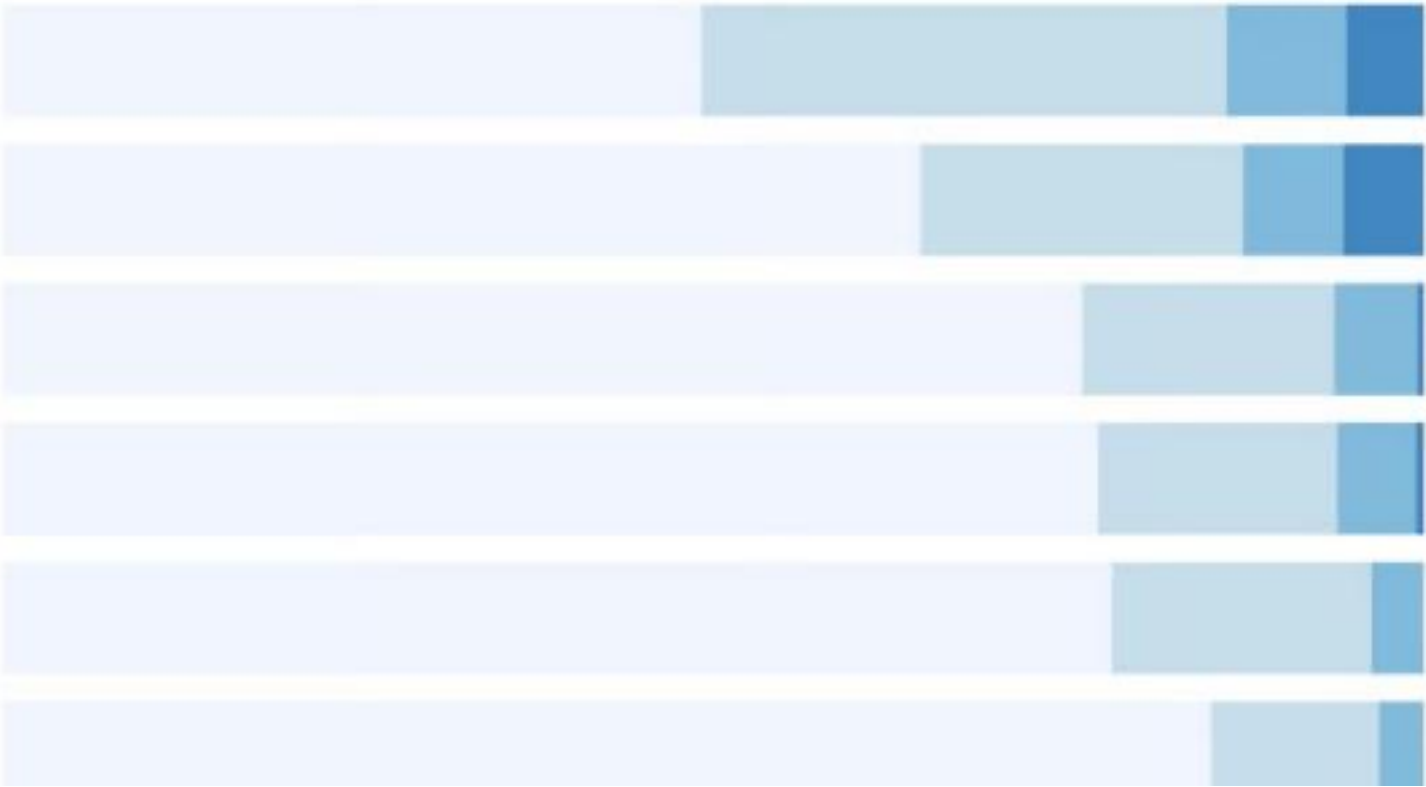
Data Challenges

Getting the data needed to understand the needs of the community is often difficult, and the data is often outdated.

How People Cope: From Medication to Faith to Family Conversations

Responses vary widely across cultures, shaped by

- Taking prescribed medication (common in higher-i
- Engaging in religious or spiritual activities (prevale
- Talking to friends or family (widely reported)



Key Takeaways: Prioritizing Depression, Anxiety, and Closing the Treatment Gap

- Depression and anxiety together represent the overwhelming majority of mental health DALYs.
- Schizophrenia and bipolar disorder carry disproportionate individual burden despite lower population prevalence.
- Treatment exists but access and quality remain inadequate globally.
- Stigma suppresses both help-seeking and accurate data collection, masking the true scale.
- Policy should prioritize scaling evidence-based interventions for common mental disorders while maintaining specialized care for severe conditions.